

Grounding Annotation Guidelines

Purpose

These guidelines document the manual grounding assessment used in phase III study. The assessment examines whether narrative content is supported by, unsupported by, or in conflict with the structured persona/activity information available to the storytelling system. Grounding is assessed separately from argumentative function: a statement may be a CLAIM, PREMISE, or NONE while independently receiving a grounding label.

1. Unit of Annotation

The unit of assessment is the statement or text unit presented for grounding review. Each applicable unit receives one grounding label. The judgement concerns consistency with the available structured persona/activity information, not whether the statement is generally credible or factually true in the world.

2. Evidence Available to the Annotator

Grounding decisions are made against the structured persona and activity information available for the corresponding narrative. Relevant evidence may include recorded activities and their associated attributes (for example, importance, enjoyment/fun, who the activity is done with, motivation, and frequency), where those attributes are available in the user model.

Do not infer additional personal facts from stereotypes, general knowledge, or assumptions about older adults. A statement is not grounded merely because it sounds reasonable.

3. Grounding Labels

GROUNDDED

Assign GROUNDDED when the statement is supported by the available persona/activity information. The wording does not need to reproduce the user-model text exactly; a faithful paraphrase or reasonable restatement of the recorded information can be grounded.

Illustrative example: If the profile records regular gardening, “Gardening is part of your routine” is GROUNDDED.

UNSUPPORTED

Assign UNSUPPORTED when the statement introduces personal information, preferences, activities, relationships, motives, outcomes, or other persona-specific content that is not supported by the available persona/activity information, while not directly conflicting with it.

Illustrative example: If the profile contains no information about swimming, “You enjoy swimming at the local pool” is UNSUPPORTED.

CONTRADICTED

Assign CONTRADICTED when the statement conflicts with the available persona/activity information.

Illustrative example: If an activity is recorded as something the persona does alone, a statement asserting that the persona regularly performs that activity with a friend is CONTRADICTED.

4. Decision Rules

- Use the structured persona/activity information as the reference evidence.
- Assess support for the specific content expressed in the unit; do not reward general credibility.
- Treat faithful paraphrases of recorded persona/activity information as GROUNDED.
- If persona-specific content is absent from the available information, label it UNSUPPORTED rather than inferring it.
- Use CONTRADICTED only when there is evidence of an actual conflict with the available persona/activity information.
- Do not use CLAIM/PREMISE/NONE labels to determine grounding. Argumentative role and grounding are separate dimensions.
- Do not treat the presence of more claims or premises as evidence of better grounding.

5. Generic Statements

Generic statements that do not assert persona-specific information require particular care. For example, a general statement such as “Movement can improve your mood” is not supported by the persona merely because the persona has a movement-related activity. It should not be counted as persona-grounded evidence unless the available persona/activity information supports the specific personal connection being asserted. The grounding analysis therefore distinguishes accurate use of the user model from generic narrative elaboration.

6. Ambiguous and Mixed Cases

When a unit contains multiple factual propositions, assess the propositions against the available persona/activity information. If the unit combines supported and unsupported or conflicting content, record the label according to the coding procedure used for the grounding dataset and document the case for review rather than silently inferring missing information. Ambiguous cases should be resolved through manual review using the same persona/activity evidence.

7. Scope and Interpretation

The grounding labels measure consistency with the available structured persona information. They do not establish general factual correctness, clinical correctness, absence of hallucination, or broad AI alignment. UNSUPPORTED content identifies information that is not supported by the available persona data; it does not necessarily mean that the statement is false.

The grounding assessment is an inspection layer for person-tailored narrative content. Argument structure, argumentation-scheme guidance, and argument-mining performance are analysed separately.

8. Reporting

Reported grounding results should state the assessment unit and denominator and should distinguish GROUNDED, UNSUPPORTED, and CONTRADICTED content. Where a sampled manual audit is used, the sampling procedure and the role of human review should be reported separately from automated argument-mining results.